

# Project Ernie — B2B Emphasis Addendum (V4.1.1)

**Purpose:** This addendum tightens positioning, scope language, and go-to-market framing so the spec reads unambiguously as a B2B finance operations product + managed service (not a consumer app).

## B2B Scope Statement (insert into Executive Summary)

Project Ernie is a B2B operating system and managed service for finance teams. It produces auditable, board-ready monthly variance memos from company financial exports (GL, budget, prior period). Ernie is sold to businesses (CFO/Controller/FP&A;), deployed under a Data Processing Agreement, and designed for data isolation, reproducibility, and SLAs. It is not intended for consumer use.

## Ideal Customer Profile (ICP) + Buyer/User Map

|                |                                                                                                           |
|----------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| ICP            | Seed–Series B SaaS / services firms; 20–250 employees; \$1M–\$30M ARR/revenue; lean finance teams         |
| Economic buyer | CFO or Founder (owns budget, board reporting).                                                            |
| Primary users  | Controller + FP&A analyst (uploads exports, reviews drafts, requests revisions).                          |
| Success metric | Board packet readiness: memo delivered within SLA; fewer close-week fire drills; fewer spreadsheet errors |

## What We Sell (B2B Value Prop)

**Promise:** “Board-ready variance memos in hours — with reproducible numbers and an audit trail.”

**Why it’s believable:** V4.1 already mandates pre-analysis validation + injection scan, exactly-once intake envelope, circuit breakers + stub mode, clean-room reviewer UI, and approvals as a system-of-record in the portal.

## Packaging + Pricing Guidance (service tiers)

| Tier       | Best for                                           | Inclusions                                                             | Indicative price                      |
|------------|----------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------|
| Starter    | Small teams needing predictable monthly reporting  | Up to 10 GL exports/month; 48h SLA; 1 data source; 1 reviewer          | \$2k–\$4k/mo                          |
| Pro        | Teams with board cadence + fast close requirements | Up to 25 GL exports/month; 24h (or 4h for close week) SLA; 3 reviewers | \$8k–\$10k/mo                         |
| Enterprise | Security/controls-heavy orgs                       | Dedicated reviewer pool; custom retention/legal-hold; 24/7 ops         | \$25k+ options; expanded audit report |

## GTM (6-week MVP → revenue)

**Design partners (max 2):** discounted 90-day pilot; weekly feedback call; allow anonymized case study.

**Sales motion:** founder-led outbound to CFOs/controllers; demo = upload → validation pass → checkpoint ID → draft memo → approval → delivery.

**Primary differentiation:** auditability (checkpoint + provenance), safety (injection + isolation + clean room), reliability (exactly-once + circuit breaker).

## **Language/Terminology Patches (make doc read B2B)**

Replace consumer-ish terms with enterprise terms consistently:

- “client” → “customer (company)”
- “user” → “finance team user”
- “human reviewer” → “finance QA reviewer”
- “Slack approval” → “Slack notification only (SoR = portal)”
- “memory” → “customer reporting profile / preferences”

Add: DPA availability, onboarding steps, and a single ICP paragraph in the Executive Summary.

## **B2B Moat: what a big platform can't 'flip a switch' on**

For finance teams, the defensibility is operational: validated intake contracts, COA template versioning, reproducible checkpoints, approval logs, reviewer SOPs, and reliability controls. A streaming platform feature is irrelevant here; the customer is buying a governed workflow, not a UI toggle.

## **Add One Section to the Main Spec: "B2B Commercialization"**

Include a short section (1–2 pages) covering ICP, pricing tiers, pilot terms, onboarding, and a compliance-ready one-liner (DPA, retention/tombstone). This prevents the spec from reading like an internal engineering memo only.